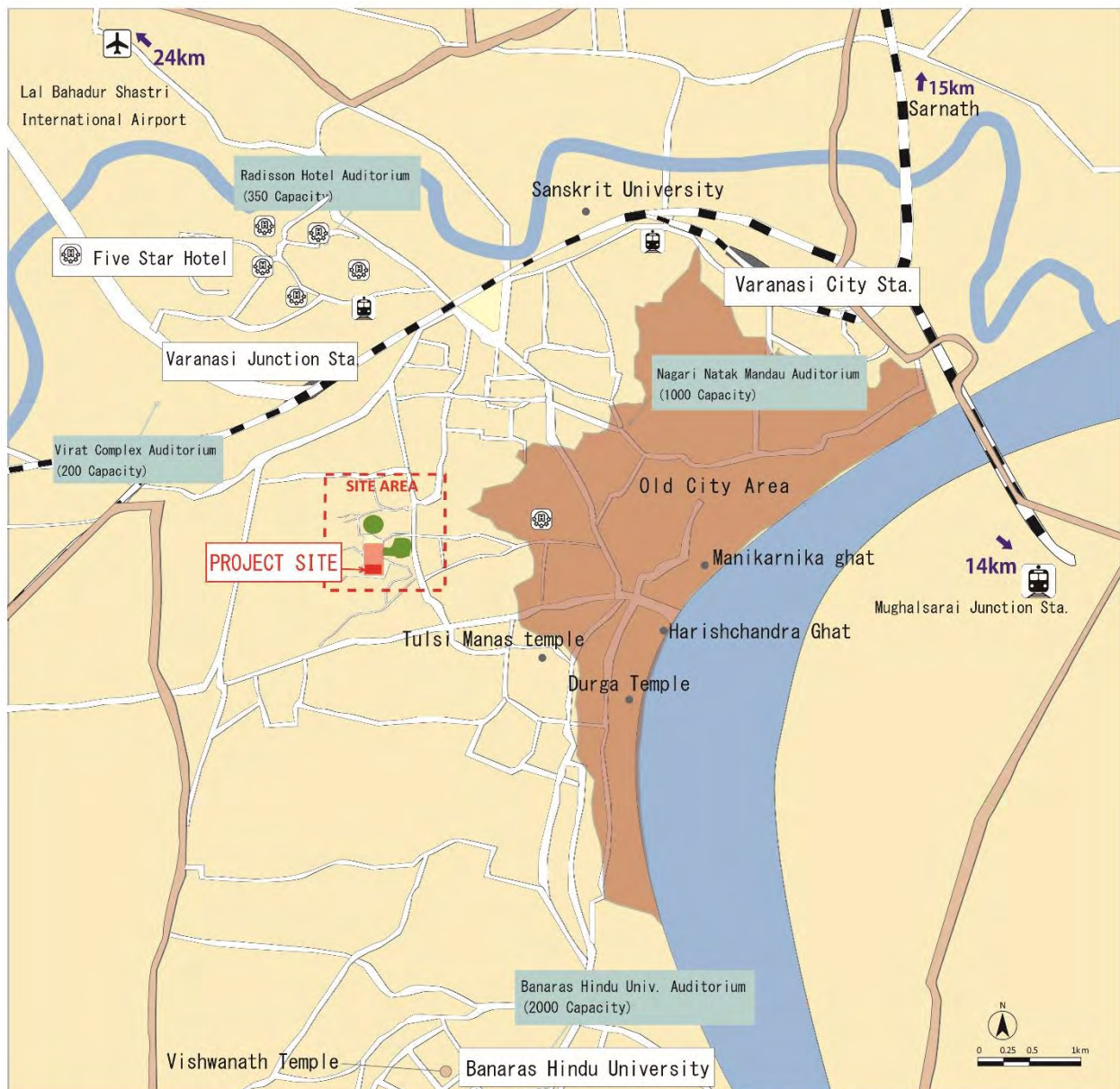




LOCATION MAP OF THE PROJECT SITE

CHAPTER 5. STUDY ON THE POSSIBILITY OF ESTABLISHMENT OF VARANASI CONVENTION CENTRE

5.1. Overview of Varanasi City

Varanasi is a city on the banks of Ganga River in UP State. This city is considered as one of the holiest cities in Hinduism and Jainism, and has played an important role in the development of Buddhism as well. It has been a cultural centre of North India for thousands of years and is a major centre for pilgrimage.

It is considered one of the oldest continuously inhabited cities in the world. The city of Varanasi is archaeologically proven to have been continuously inhabited by humans since ca. 800 BC and therefore described as one of the most ancient and continuously living cities in the world.

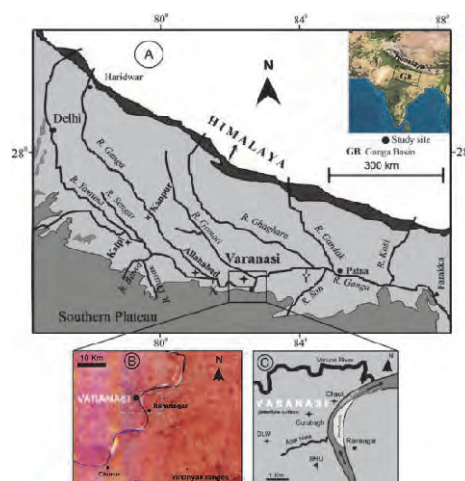
(1) Geographical Location

Varanasi City is the centre of Varanasi District in UP State which has 71 districts. Varanasi City is located in 25°15' to 25°22' north latitude and 82°57' to 83°01' east longitude, 80.71m above sea level, with the state capital Lucknow 320 Km south-east and Allahabad, 121 Km east. Ganga river flows from south to north of Varanasi and has the world famous Ghats on the West side bank.

Traditional etymology of "Varanasi" is said to come from the two Ganges tributaries forming the city's borders: Varuna in northern Varanasi, and Assi a small stream in the southern part of the city.

(2) Climate

Varanasi experiences a humid subtropical climate with large variations between summer and winter temperatures. The dry summer starts in April and lasts until June, followed by the monsoon season from July to October. The temperature ranges between 22 and 46 °C (72 and 115 °F) in summer. Winter in Varanasi has very large diurnal variations, with warm days and cold nights. Cold waves from the Himalayan region cause temperatures to dip across the city in winter from December to February and temperatures below 5 °C (41 °F) are not uncommon. The average annual rainfall is 1,110 mm (44 in). Fog is common in winter, while hot dry winds, called loo, blow in summer.



Source: <https://www.researchgate.net/>

Figure 5.1.1 Location of Varanasi

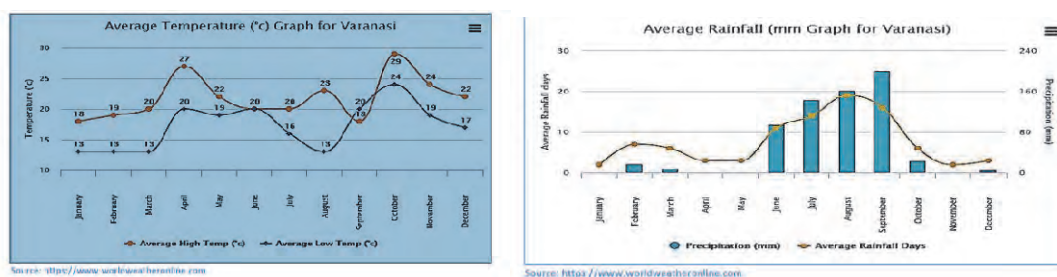


Figure 5.1.2 Average Temperature and Average Rainfall in Varanasi

(3) Demographic Information

According to Census 2011, total population of UP state was 199.8 million, and that of Varanasi District was 3.78 million, which accounts for 1.84% of the total state population. There are 39 urban centres in the district, and Varanasi City is one of the largest urban centres in the state.

The population in Varanasi Urban Agglomeration (VUA) area was 1.424 million in 2011, of which 1.19 million were in Varanasi City area. The population density of Varanasi City (82.1 sqkm) was 146 per hectare in 2011, an increase from 133 per hectare in 2001. VUA's population growth from 2001 to 2011 was 18%, which is above the national average of 17.64%.

Population growth in Varanasi is predicted as shown in Figure 5.1.3 in the “City Development Plan for Varanasi, 2041_ Capacity Building for Urban Development Project (CBUD)”.



Source: CDP 2041, Varanasi

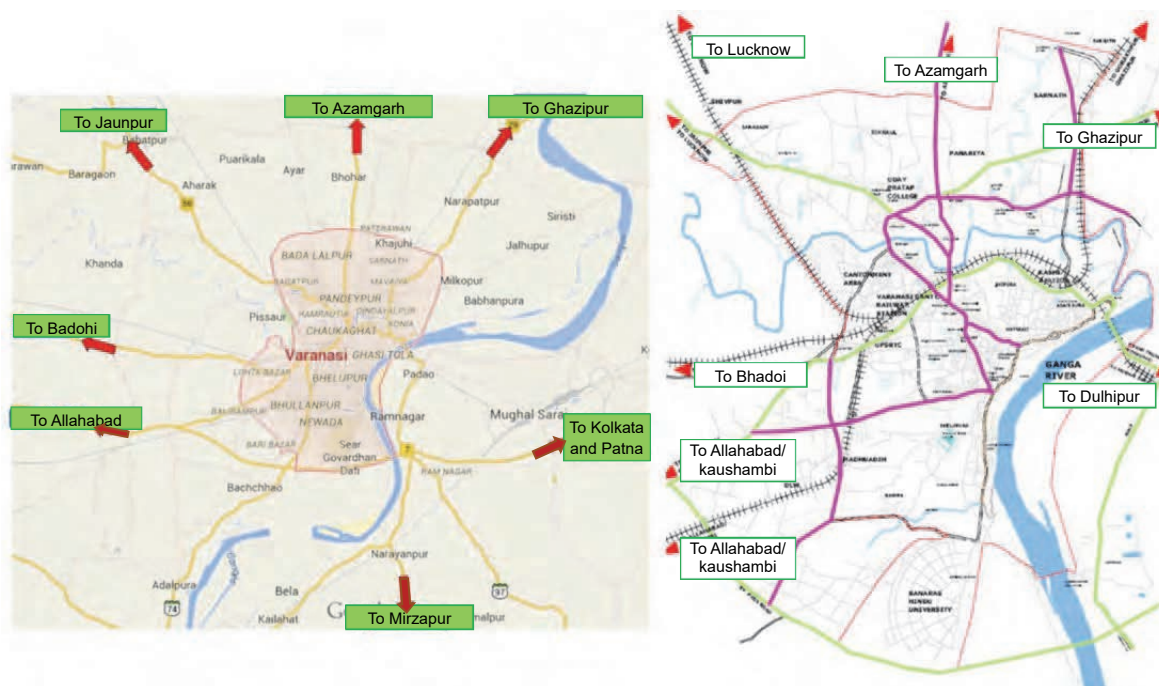
Figure 5.1.3 Population of Varanasi Urban Agglomeration

(4) Linkages and Connectivity

Varanasi is well-connected and is accessible by road, rail and air. The distances from major cities are: Delhi-750 km, Lucknow-286 km and Allahabad -125 km. There are three national highways and four state highways passing through the heart of the city.

Varanasi is also well connected by railways with broad gauge. There are three rail lines entering the city from Lucknow, Bhadoi and Allahabad, which divert into the two lines to Gorakhpur and Mughal Sarai. The city lies on the Delhi-Kolkata rail route of the North Eastern Railways, which is a broad gauge. A rail line connects the town with Sarnath. Other cities having good connectivity through railways are Patna, Guwahati, Chennai, Mumbai, Gwalior, Meerut, Lucknow, Kanpur and Allahabad. The town also has an airport at a distance of about 24 km from the city. There are flights to Varanasi from Agra, Bhubaneswar,

Kolkata, Delhi, Gorakhpur, Khajuraho, Lucknow, Raipur and Kathmandu (Nepal). It is on a regular aviation route from Delhi to Kolkata and Bhubaneshwar. It is also the aviation gateway to Nepal.

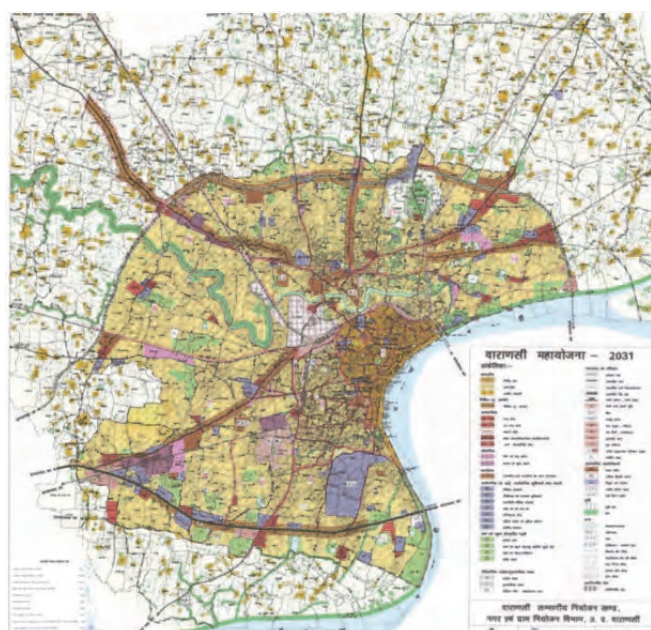


Source: DPR

Figure 5.1.4 Linkages and Connectivity

(5) Master Plan of Varanasi -2031

The Varanasi Master plan 2031 was developed in 2013 by Varanasi Development Authority (hereinafter referred to as “VDA”), but it is still under the approval process. This master plan defines the new boundary of Varanasi Development Region (VDR), new road network and land use, including new ring roads and commercial areas. The land use of the project site for VCC is for office use (refer to Chapter 5.3.2)



Source: Master Plan Varanasi 2031

Figure 5.1.5 Master Plan –Varanasi 2031

VDA, the ensuring agency of the planned expansion of the city, is also planning a Varanasi Metro as a part of Master Plan –Varanasi 2031. Two corridors are proposed: Corridor 1 connects between BHU and BHEL (Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd) and Corridor 2 between Benia Bagh and Sarnath. The traffic demand estimated for the corridors of Varanasi Metro is about 24,000 passengers for Corridor 1 and 18,000 passengers for Corridor 2.



Note: Liable to change.

Source: DPR

Figure 5.1.6 Metro Corridors and Station Locations

(6) Kyoto-Varanasi Partner City Promotion

The Prime Minister of India Mr. Narendra Modi and the Prime Minister of Japan Mr. Abe announced an agreement to promote the Kyoto-Varanasi Partner City in 2014. This agreement included culture, art, academics, heritage conservation and city modernization as potential areas of cooperation.

This Partnership is expected to facilitate as follows;

- Modernisation of Varanasi, including upgrading water management and sewage facilities, waste management, urban transportation etc., drawing upon Japan's expertise and technologies;
- Application of Japanese practices, techniques and management for conservation of the rich heritage of Varanasi; and
- Exchanges between Kyoto University and Banares Hindu University (hereinafter referred to as "BHU"), as well as religious organisations.

Source: December 3, 2014, the Press Information Bureau (PIB) of the GOI's MOUD

In addition, the memorandum for academic cooperation and exchange and a student exchange agreement between Kyoto University and BHU were concluded in August 7, 2015. BHU is the first university in India with which Kyoto University has concluded agreements for academic cooperation